12-30 第1篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The Evening Mum and I Wrote Two Letters to Our Future Selves

① On the evening of **Thursday 30 December 2027**, the last Thursday of our year, Mum and I did something we had never done before. From **19:40 to 22:05** — two hours and twenty-five minutes — we sat at the small square oak table in our living room, under the warm yellow lamp, and wrote, slowly and in total silence, **two long handwritten letters to our future selves**. Her letter was to the **Mum of 30 December 2028**, one year from that very night. My letter was to the **Yiran of 30 December 2032**, five years from that very night — the Yiran who would, by then, be eighteen, just about to graduate from high school, and possibly, quietly, already at a university somewhere on the long green campus of a city she had not yet chosen. Neither of us knew, when we sat down at 19:40, that we would still be writing twenty-five minutes after the short bell of ten o'clock.

② The idea had been Mum's, two days before. On the evening of 28 December, she had come home late from the hospital carrying a small brown paper envelope with two plain A4 envelopes and two small pieces of cream-coloured writing paper inside. She had put them on the kitchen table and said, *"Yiran, this year has been a long year. I think, on 30 December, you and I should each write one letter — one letter — not to each other, not to anyone living, but to the two of us who will be alive, still in this family, one year and five years from now. Then we will seal the two envelopes, put them in the high cupboard, and open them on the correct nights. Would that be a thing you would like to do?"* I had paused for about four seconds, and then said, in a voice smaller than I meant, *"Yes, Mum."*

③ At **19:40 on 30 December**, Mum laid two sheets of the cream paper on the oak table — one in front of each of us — along with two ordinary black ball-point pens. She had made two small cups of warm chrysanthemum tea. She had put on, unusually, her old winter reading cardigan, the dark-green one with the elbow patch I remembered from my childhood. Then she said, softly, *"Write slowly. No crossing-out. We will not read each other's letters — not tonight, not next year, not ever. Only our future selves will read them. Begin when you are ready."* Then she bowed her head slightly, picked up her pen, and began to write on her own paper, without looking at mine.

④ My pen hovered above the paper for almost six minutes before I wrote my first word. I did not know how to speak to **the Yiran of 2032**. She would be **five years taller than me**, wearing clothes I had not yet bought, living in a city I had not yet visited, loving people I had not yet met, worried about university exams I did not yet understand. Then, slowly, I wrote the first line: *"Dear Yiran, age 18 — it is me, Yiran, age 13, writing to you on a cold*

Thursday night in December 2027. I do not know you, and you do not remember me very well, so let me tell you some small quiet things about tonight, so that, five winters from now, you will not have forgotten who you were when this letter was begun." After that one line, the rest of the letter came out more easily — not in a rush, not in a flood, but in the way winter tea is slowly poured: carefully, honestly, a little at a time.

⑤ I wrote, among other things: about Silent-Reading Morning and how Mr Qin's thin copy of *Journey to the West* had been the quietest thing in a classroom all year; about the afternoon I took care of Grandpa's 38.9°C fever alone and understood, for the first time, what Mum's daily tiredness really meant; about the kind night cleaner at Longhua South who returned my maths book and refused to tell me his name; about the Christmas Eve Granny and I made thirty small cards for Sunshine Elderly Home, and about Card 28 for Grandpa Lu, the retired primary-school teacher, and how Granny's eyes had been wet as she wrote. I wrote: *"Yiran, I do not know which of these small things you will still remember at 18. But please, at least, remember that at 13 you were a small quiet girl who slowly learned that kindness is rarely loud and never ranked."* I wrote: *"If you are sad at 18, I hope you will remember that a thirteen-year-old version of you once cried only for four minutes, and only after Grandpa was safely asleep, and that she did not break. You will not break either."* I wrote: *"If the world at 18 has become faster than you can chase, I hope you will walk at the pace of a grandmother, and think at the pace of a cloud. The pace will find you the right small answers."*

⑥ I did not look up at Mum for the entire two hours, and she did not look up at me. At **21:56**, I put my pen down. My letter was **seven pages long**. Mum's letter — which I could see from the corner of my eye — was **three pages long**, each line a slightly slower handwriting than usual, and she was still writing. I sat quietly and waited. At **22:05**, Mum too put her pen down and gave a small sigh, the kind of sigh that contains, at the same time, tiredness and relief and a tiny laugh at one's own softness. Then she folded her three pages carefully into thirds, slid them into one of the A4 envelopes, sealed it, and wrote on the front, in her slow round handwriting: *"To Mum, 30 December 2028 — open with a cup of warm tea, no children watching."* I folded my seven pages, slid them into the other envelope, sealed it, and wrote: *"To Yiran, 30 December 2032 — open quietly, alone, in a small light."*

⑦ Mum stood up, carried a small step-stool to the high kitchen cupboard above the rice pot, placed both sealed envelopes on the top shelf between a cookbook and an old photo album, and stepped down. Then she turned to me and said, very quietly, *"Yiran, we will not speak of these letters again. Not next month. Not next year. If you remember them on the correct date, you remember them. If you forget, that is also fine. The letters know how to wait."* I nodded. We drank the cold chrysanthemum tea that had been sitting untouched since 19:40, and we went, without another word, to bed. As I lay in bed at **22:40**, I understood, for the first real time, a small sentence that Granny had once whispered to me in October: **the most important conversations in our lives are not always with the people in the next room, but sometimes with the quiet future versions of ourselves — who, years from now, will read what we wrote on a cold December**

night and will know, with a warmth that needs no words, that we had, once, remembered them in advance.

注释： chrysanthemum tea 菊花茶；cardigan 开衫毛衣；elbow patch 肘部补丁；step-stool 小凳子；cookbook 食谱；chrysanthemum 菊花

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What did the narrator and her mother do on the evening of 30 December 2027, and to whom were their letters addressed?

A. They wrote short emails to each other and posted them the same night.
B. From 19:40 to 22:05 on Thursday 30 December 2027 — two hours and twenty-five minutes — the narrator and her mother sat at the small square oak table under the warm yellow lamp and wrote, slowly and in total silence, two long handwritten letters to their future selves: Mum's letter was to the Mum of 30 December 2028, one year from that very night; Yiran's letter was to the Yiran of 30 December 2032, five years from that very night — the Yiran who would by then be eighteen, possibly at a university on a long green campus in a city she had not yet chosen; neither of them knew, when they sat down, that they would still be writing twenty-five minutes after the short bell of ten o'clock.
C. They read old letters to each other all night and did not write anything.
D. They sent each other voice messages over WeChat without writing.

2. How did Mum first propose the idea, and what was Yiran's reply?

A. Mum demanded the writing as a weekly homework and Yiran refused.
B. Mum suggested writing letters in English only and Yiran had to translate them.
C. On the evening of 28 December, Mum came home late from the hospital carrying a small brown paper envelope with two plain A4 envelopes and two small pieces of cream-coloured writing paper, put them on the kitchen table, and said, "Yiran, this year has been a long year. I think on 30 December you and I should each write one letter — one letter — not to each other, not to anyone living, but to the two of us who will be alive, still in this family, one year and five years from now. Then we will seal the two envelopes, put them in the high cupboard, and open them on the correct nights. Would that be a thing you would like to do?"; the narrator paused for about four seconds and then said, in a voice smaller than she meant, "Yes, Mum."
D. Mum proposed the idea after midnight on New Year's Eve for the next day.

3. What rules did Mum set before they began writing at 19:40 on 30 December?

A. Mum laid two sheets of cream paper on the oak table — one in front of each — along with two ordinary black ball-point pens; she had made two small cups of warm chrysanthemum tea; she was wearing her old winter reading cardigan, the dark-green one with the elbow patch from Yiran's childhood; and she said softly, "Write slowly. No

crossing-out. We will not read each other's letters — not tonight, not next year, not ever. Only our future selves will read them. Begin when you are ready."; then she bowed her head slightly, picked up her pen, and began to write on her own paper without looking at Yiran's.
B. Mum insisted they check each other's letters after every paragraph.
C. Mum told Yiran to type the letter on a tablet and upload it to the cloud.
D. Mum demanded the letters be read aloud to the whole extended family.

4. What are some of the things Yiran chose to write in her letter to her 18-year-old self?

A. Yiran wrote only about her future university scores and bank balance.
B. Yiran refused to write anything and left the page blank.
C. Yiran wrote about Silent-Reading Morning and Mr Qin's thin copy of Journey to the West; about the afternoon she cared for Grandpa's 38.9°C fever alone and understood Mum's daily tiredness; about the kind night cleaner at Longhua South who returned her maths book and refused to give his name; about Christmas Eve when she and Granny made thirty small cards for Sunshine Elderly Home, and Card 28 to Grandpa Lu the retired primary-school teacher with Granny's wet eyes; she wrote "Yiran, I do not know which of these small things you will still remember at 18. But please, at least, remember that at 13 you were a small quiet girl who slowly learned that kindness is rarely loud and never ranked.", "If you are sad at 18, I hope you will remember that a thirteen-year-old version of you once cried only for four minutes, and only after Grandpa was safely asleep, and that she did not break. You will not break either.", and "If the world at 18 has become faster than you can chase, I hope you will walk at the pace of a grandmother, and think at the pace of a cloud. The pace will find you the right small answers."
D. Yiran wrote insults about her classmates and a long list of complaints.

5. What is the main understanding Yiran reached at 22:40 in bed that night?

A. That the most important conversations in our lives are always loud and public.
B. That the only valuable letters are those that reach other living people quickly.
C. That the most important conversations in our lives are not always with the people in the next room, but sometimes with the quiet future versions of ourselves — who, years from now, will read what we wrote on a cold December night and will know, with a warmth that needs no words, that we had, once, remembered them in advance; as Granny had whispered to her in October and as she now understood for the first real time.
D. That letters should be opened the day after they are written.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B

【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段
【解析】"12.30 周四 19:40–22:05 / 妈→1 年后 / 伊然→5 年后 18 岁"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段
【解析】"28 日医院 / 两信 / 一年 + 五年 / 4 秒小声 Yes"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

3.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段
【解析】"慢写 / 不修 / 互不读 / 唯未来我读"直引。B、C、D 均错。故选 A。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段
【解析】"Silent-Reading / 38.9 / 清洁工 / Card 28 卢老师 / 不裂不慢不怕"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑦段
【解析】"22:40 悟 / 最重对话或与未来自己 / 奶奶十月话 / 预先被记挂之暖"主旨。A、B、D 均偏离。故选 C。